ABC Private Limited

Technology, Data and Cloud Services | Kolkata - Bengaluru - Pune - Hyderabad

Corporate Policy Handbook

Company Profile, Hiring Policy, Working Policy and HR Policy

Field	Details
Document ID	ABC-POL-HB-2026-01
Version	4.2 (supersedes v4.1 dated 01 April 2025)
Effective date	01 April 2026
Next scheduled review	31 March 2027
Document owner	Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO), Office of People and Culture
Approved by	Managing Director and the Board Human Resources Committee
Applicability	All permanent, probationary, fixed-term and intern employees of ABC Private Limited in India
Classification	Internal - for employee use

Disclaimer: ABC Private Limited is a fictional company. All names, numbers, policies, addresses and e-mail IDs in this handbook are invented for demonstration and testing purposes (for example, as a sample knowledge base for a Retrieval-Augmented Generation project). Any resemblance to a real organisation is coincidental.

Table of Contents

1. About ABC Private Limited 3

2. Organisation Structure and Departments 4

3. Hiring and Recruitment Policy 5

4. Employee Categories and Grade Structure 7

5. Working Policy 8

6. Leave Policy 10

7. Compensation and Benefits Policy 11

8. Employee Code of Conduct and Ethics 13

9. Performance Management and Career Progression 14

10. Learning and Development Policy 15

11. Disciplinary Policy and Grievance Redressal 15

12. Separation, Exit and Retirement Policy 16

13. Health, Safety and Wellness Policy 17

14. Information Security and IT Usage Policy 17

15. Travel and Expense Policy 18

16. Frequently Asked Questions 19

17. Contacts, Glossary and Document Control 20

1. About ABC Private Limited

1.1 Company Overview

ABC Private Limited ("ABC", "the Company") is an India-headquartered technology services and product company founded on 14 July 2009 by Dr. Sourav Mukherjee and Ms. Ritika Sen in a rented 2,400 sq. ft. office in Salt Lake, Kolkata. The Company is incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 (CIN: U72900WB2009PTC136482 - illustrative) and has its registered office at Tower C, 9th Floor, Webel Boulevard, Sector V, Salt Lake, Kolkata - 700091, West Bengal. ABC designs, builds and operates enterprise software, data platforms, cloud infrastructure and AI solutions for clients in banking and insurance, healthcare, retail, logistics and the public sector.

As on 31 March 2026 the Company employs 2,320 people (about 180 additional contract and consulting staff work with ABC at any given time), serves 146 active clients across 14 countries and reported consolidated revenue of INR 1,184 crore for FY 2025-26. The Company was certified Great Place to Work in 2023, 2024 and 2025 and holds ISO/IEC 27001:2022 (information security) and ISO 9001:2015 (quality) certifications.

1.2 Vision, Mission and Core Values

Vision: To be the most trusted engineering partner for organisations that want to turn data into decisions.

Mission: To deliver reliable, secure and human-centred technology while creating a workplace where every employee can learn, lead and grow.

ABC's culture is built on five core values, abbreviated as **C.R.A.F.T.**:

- **Curiosity** - we ask why, and we keep learning.
- **Responsibility** - we own outcomes for clients, colleagues and the community.
- **Accountability and Integrity** - we do what we say, and we say what is true.
- **Fairness and Respect** - we treat every person with dignity, irrespective of background.
- **Teamwork** - we win together; credit is shared and failures are learned from, not blamed.

1.3 Key Facts at a Glance

Item	Detail
Founded	14 July 2009, Kolkata
Founders	Dr. Sourav Mukherjee (Chairman and Managing Director); Ms. Ritika Sen (Executive Director, Strategy)
Business lines	Software Engineering Services, Data and AI, Cloud and Infrastructure, Cybersecurity, Managed Services, Product (ABC Insight Suite)
Employees (31 Mar 2026)	2,320 (women: 36.4%; average age: 31.2 years; average tenure: 3.9 years)
Offices	Kolkata (HQ, 1,020 staff), Bengaluru (610), Pune (380), Hyderabad (310); small client-site teams in Mumbai and Delhi NCR
International presence	Sales and delivery offices in London (UK), Singapore and Dubai (UAE); a US sales entity in Austin, Texas
Financial year	1 April to 31 March
Attrition (FY 2025-26)	13.8% voluntary, 15.1% total
HR helpdesk	hr-helpdesk@abc-pvt.example | Extension 4100 | Mon-Fri, 09:00-18:00 IST

1.4 Leadership Team

Role	Name
Chairman and Managing Director	Dr. Sourav Mukherjee
Executive Director, Strategy	Ms. Ritika Sen
Chief Executive Officer	Mr. Anand Krishnamurthy
Chief Operating Officer	Ms. Neha Banerjee
Chief Technology Officer	Mr. Vikram Rao

Role	Name
Chief Financial Officer	Mr. Sandeep Agarwal
Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO)	Ms. Debjani Ghosh
Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)	Mr. Imran Qureshi
General Counsel and Company Secretary	Ms. Prerna Joshi

2. Organisation Structure and Departments

ABC follows a matrix structure: employees report administratively to a department and work operationally in client delivery pods led by a Delivery Manager. Every department is headed by a Vice President or Director who reports to the COO, CTO, CFO or CHRO. The CEO chairs the monthly Executive Operating Committee (EOC) that reviews all departments.

2.1 Departments, Heads and Headcount (31 March 2026)

Department	Head	Headcount	Primary function
Engineering and Delivery	Mr. Rohit Deshmukh (VP)	1,150	Custom software development, integration, client project delivery
Data and AI	Dr. Ananya Chatterjee (Director)	210	Data engineering, analytics, machine learning, generative AI solutions
Cloud and Infrastructure	Mr. Karthik Subramanian (Director)	180	Cloud migration, DevOps, site reliability, managed hosting
Quality Assurance and Testing	Ms. Shalini Nair (Director)	160	Test automation, performance and security testing, release certification
Sales and Business Development	Mr. Arjun Malhotra (VP)	110	Pre-sales, account management, partnerships and proposals
Product Management	Ms. Meera Iyer (Director)	90	Roadmap and delivery of the ABC Insight Suite analytics product
Cybersecurity	Mr. Imran Qureshi (CISO)	75	Security operations, governance, risk and compliance, red teaming
Customer Success	Mr. Tanmoy Dutta (Director)	70	Post-sales support, SLAs, renewals and customer satisfaction
Admin and Facilities	Mr. Pradeep Kulkarni (Sr. Manager)	60	Offices, transport, security, cafeterias, travel desk
Finance and Accounts	Mr. Sandeep Agarwal (CFO)	52	Accounting, treasury, payroll finance, audit, tax, FP and A
Human Resources (People and Culture)	Ms. Debjani Ghosh (CHRO)	48	Talent acquisition, HR operations, compensation, learning, engagement, employee relations
Marketing and Communications	Ms. Sneha Pillai (Director)	45	Brand, events, content, digital marketing, internal communications
Internal IT Systems	Mr. Faisal Ahmed (Sr. Manager)	40	Employee laptops, collaboration tools, ERP and HRMS support
Legal and Compliance	Ms. Prerna Joshi (General Counsel)	18	Contracts, statutory compliance, intellectual property, POSH compliance
Procurement	Mr. Gaurav Bhatia (Manager)	12	Vendor selection, purchase orders, vendor onboarding

2.2 Human Resources Function

The HR function (named "People and Culture") is organised into six teams: (1) Talent Acquisition, (2) HR Business Partners (HRBPs), (3) HR Operations and Payroll, (4) Compensation and Benefits, (5) Learning and Development (L and D), and (6) Employee Engagement and Employee Relations. Each department is assigned a dedicated HRBP. HRBPs are the first point of contact for policy interpretation, performance concerns and grievances beyond the reporting manager.

2.3 Reporting and Escalation Matrix

Level	Who	Typical matters
Level 1	Reporting Manager	Day-to-day work, leave approval, feedback, first-level grievances
Level 2	Department Head and HRBP	Role changes, policy exceptions, unresolved grievances, performance improvement plans
Level 3	Grievance Redressal Committee (GRC)	Escalated grievances, harassment complaints outside POSH scope, disputed ratings
Level 4	CHRO	Final internal appeal on HR matters; exceptions for G6 and above
Special	Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)	Sexual harassment complaints under the POSH Act, 2013
Special	Ethics and Whistleblower Committee	Fraud, bribery, accounting irregularities, serious code-of-conduct breaches

3. Hiring and Recruitment Policy

3.1 Purpose and Principles

This policy ensures that ABC hires the right people, in a fair, lawful and timely manner. All hiring is merit-based, and no candidate shall be discriminated against on the basis of gender, caste, religion, region, marital status, sexual orientation, disability or age. ABC has set a target of 40% women in new hires and 35% women in its total workforce by March 2028. The Company also follows an **Accessible Hiring Commitment**: reasonable adjustments in tests, interview locations and tools are provided to candidates with disabilities on request.

3.2 Manpower Planning and Requisition Approval

- Annual headcount budgets are approved in February for the next financial year by the CFO, COO and CHRO.
- A hiring manager raises an electronic Job Requisition (JR) in the HRMS (named **PeopleHub**) with role title, grade, skills, location, budget band and justification (new position or replacement).
- Approval chain: Department Head, then Finance Business Partner, then HRBP. Requisitions for grade G7 and above also need CHRO and CEO approval.
- Unapproved hiring, verbal offers and "parking" candidates without a JR are not allowed.
- A requisition is valid for 90 days; if unfilled, it must be re-validated by the Department Head.

3.3 Sourcing Channels

Talent Acquisition (TA) sources candidates through the following channels, in the order of preference: (1) internal job postings, (2) employee referrals, (3) campus hiring, (4) the careers page and professional networks, (5) approved recruitment agencies, and (6) walk-in drives and hackathons. Recruitment agencies are used only for G5 and above or niche skills, and must be empanelled by Procurement. Agency fees are capped at 8.33% of annual fixed CTC (one month's salary) for G5-G6 and 12% for G7 and above, payable only after the candidate completes 90 days.

3.4 Internal Job Posting (IJP)

- All open positions up to G6 are first posted internally on PeopleHub for 7 calendar days.
- Eligibility: minimum 12 months in the current role, performance rating of 3 ("Meets Expectations") or above in the last cycle, no active Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) and no disciplinary action in the last 12 months.
- The employee may apply without the current manager's permission, but must inform the manager after being shortlisted. The release date is decided by mutual agreement and must not exceed 60 days.
- An internal candidate who is selected moves with their existing grade; a grade change is a promotion and follows the promotion policy in Section 9.

3.5 Employee Referral Programme

Employees may refer friends and former colleagues through the Refer and Earn portal. Referral bonuses are paid with the salary of the month following the referred candidate's completion of 90 days of service.

Grade of hire	Referral bonus (INR)	Notes
G1 - G3	25,000	Per successful hire
G4 - G5	50,000	Per successful hire
G6 and above	1,00,000	Per successful hire; CHRO approval required
Niche skills (Gen AI, cybersecurity architects, SAP S/4HANA)	Additional 15,000	Added on top of the grade-based bonus

Members of the HR and Talent Acquisition teams, the hiring manager, and anyone in the hiring panel are not eligible for referral bonuses for that role. Referrer and referred employee must both be in service on the payout date.

3.6 Selection Process

Stage	Description	Owner
1. Resume screening	Match against JR criteria within 3 working days	Talent Acquisition
2. Online assessment	Aptitude, coding or domain test (60-90 minutes); cut-off 60%	TA with Assessment Team
3. Technical interview 1	Core skills, problem solving (45-60 minutes)	Panel of two engineers
4. Technical interview 2	Design, architecture or case study (for G3 and above)	Senior engineer or Architect
5. Managerial round	Role fit, ownership, stakeholder handling	Hiring Manager
6. HR round	Values (C.R.A.F.T.), motivation, compensation discussion, notice period	HRBP or TA Lead
7. Leadership round	Mandatory for G6 and above	Department Head and COO or CEO

Every interviewer must submit written feedback in PeopleHub within 24 hours using the 5-point competency scale. A hire needs a unanimous "Hire" or "Strong Hire" recommendation from the technical and managerial rounds. Interviewers may not interview relatives or close friends and must declare such conflicts. Target time-to-offer, from approved requisition to rolled-out offer, is 30 days for G1-G4 and 45 days for G5 and above.

3.7 Eligibility Criteria

- **Freshers (G1):** B.E./B.Tech/M.Tech/MCA/M.Sc (CS or IT) with minimum 60% or CGPA 6.5 in graduation and no active backlog at the time of joining. Gaps in education beyond 2 years need justification.
- **Experienced hires:** relevant degree and experience as per JR; a maximum of 90-day unexplained career gap is acceptable, longer gaps are reviewed by the HRBP.
- **Age:** minimum 18 years at joining; there is no upper age limit except where the law requires one.
- **Dual employment:** not allowed. Candidates must disclose any ongoing employment or freelance commitments.

3.8 Campus Hiring

ABC visits around 28 partner engineering colleges every year in the months of August to December and runs an off-campus drive in February. Selected students receive a Pre-Placement Offer (PPO) or a campus offer for G1 "Graduate Engineer Trainee (GET)" and join on or after 1 July. GETs undergo an 8-week induction and training academy ("ABC Launchpad") before project allocation. The fixed CTC for GETs in FY 2026-27 is INR 4.5 lakh (standard track) and INR 7.5 lakh (Digital and AI track).

3.9 Offer, Joining Bonus and Documentation

- Offers are generated in PeopleHub only after the compensation is approved by the Compensation and Benefits team within the grade band.
- Offer letters are valid for 10 calendar days. The maximum period between acceptance and joining is 60 days (90 days for G6 and above); extensions need HRBP approval.

- Joining bonuses are offered only for G4 and above, with a maximum of 15% of fixed CTC, paid in the first payroll after joining and subject to **clawback** in full if the employee resigns within 12 months, or 50% if between 12 and 18 months.
- Relocation assistance: lump-sum of INR 40,000 within India (INR 1,00,000 for G6 and above) and up to 15 days of temporary accommodation.

Documents required on the date of joining: government photo ID (Aadhaar), PAN card, passport-size photographs, educational certificates and mark-sheets, relieving letter and last three payslips from previous employers, address proof, bank account details, UAN number (if any) and a signed copy of the offer letter and Code of Conduct.

3.10 Background Verification (BV)

All offers are conditional upon a satisfactory background verification, conducted by an external agency and completed within 21 working days of joining. BV covers education, last two employers, address, criminal record and, for G6 and above, a credit and directorship check. Any material misrepresentation or discrepancy found - including forged documents, hidden employment or false experience claims - may lead to termination without notice and without any compensation.

3.11 Probation, Confirmation and Rehire

- All employees from G1 to G5 serve a probation period of 6 months (G6 and above: 3 months). It may be extended once, by a maximum of 3 months, if performance needs improvement.
- A confirmation letter is issued within 15 days after the manager's and HRBP's approval. If no communication is received, the employee continues on probation until confirmation is issued in writing.
- During probation the notice period is 15 days from either side.
- **Rehire:** former employees who left in good standing and after serving full notice are eligible for rehire after a cooling-off of 6 months. Employees terminated for misconduct, or who absconded, are permanently ineligible. Past service is not counted for gratuity and leave unless the break is less than 90 days and approved by the CHRO.

4. Employee Categories and Grade Structure

4.1 Categories of Employment

Category	Definition	Benefits
Permanent	Full-time employee confirmed after probation	Full benefits as in this handbook
Probationer	Newly hired, not yet confirmed	All benefits except Performance Bonus eligibility in the first cycle and PL encashment
Fixed-term contract	Hired for a defined project or period of 6-24 months	Statutory benefits, medical insurance and PL; no ESOP, no variable pay unless specified
Intern	Student or graduate on internship of 2-6 months	Monthly stipend of INR 15,000-25,000, access to training, no leave except 1 day per month
Consultant / Contractor	Engaged via a service contract; not an employee	As per contract; not covered by this handbook except Code of Conduct and security policies

4.2 Grade Structure

Grade	Typical designations	Typical years of experience	Notice period
G1	Graduate Engineer Trainee, Management Trainee	0 - 1	30 days
G2	Associate Engineer, Associate Executive	1 - 3	30 days
G3	Engineer, Senior Executive, Analyst	3 - 5	30 days
G4	Senior Engineer, Assistant Manager, Senior Analyst	5 - 8	60 days
G5	Technical Lead, Manager, Principal Analyst	8 - 12	60 days
G6	Senior Manager, Architect	12 - 15	90 days
G7	Associate Director, Senior Architect	15 - 18	90 days

Grade	Typical designations	Typical years of experience	Notice period
G8	Director, Vice President	18 - 22	90 days
G9	Senior Vice President and above; C-suite	22+	90 days

Grades G1 and G2 are classified as **non-exempt** employees for overtime purposes; G3 and above are **exempt** and are not entitled to overtime pay.

5. Working Policy

5.1 Working Days and Hours

- Standard working week: Monday to Friday. Saturdays and Sundays are weekly offs, except for employees in the Customer Success and Managed Services shifts, whose roster-based week-offs are approved in advance.
- Standard working time is 9 hours per day, including a 1-hour break, i.e., 45 hours per week. The standard shift is 09:30 to 18:30 IST.
- **Core collaboration hours** are 11:00 to 16:00 IST, during which all employees must be reachable for meetings.
- Employees working in rotational shifts (night, UK or US overlap) receive a shift allowance: INR 150 for the evening shift (14:00-23:00), INR 350 for the night shift (22:00-07:00) per working day, and free drop-and-pick cab service between 20:00 and 07:00.
- No employee should be scheduled for more than 12 hours of work in a day, or more than 60 hours in a week, in any circumstance.

5.2 Hybrid Work Model

ABC follows a hybrid model called **"3-2 Flex"**. Employees are expected to be present in the office on **Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Thursdays** (three anchor days) and may work from home on Mondays and Fridays, subject to the manager's approval and project needs. Key rules:

- Client-site employees follow the client's calendar. Employees in the first 90 days after joining (and all G1 trainees during Launchpad) work from the office five days a week.
- Work From Home (WFH) is not allowed from outside the registered city without written approval from the Department Head. Work From Anywhere (WFA) is allowed for a maximum of 20 working days per financial year, within India, with HRBP and security approval.
- Employees must have a stable internet connection (minimum 25 Mbps), a safe and confidential workspace, and must use the Company's VPN at all times. A monthly internet and utility reimbursement of INR 1,000 is paid to all employees who work from home for more than 6 days a month.
- Managers may call employees to the office for critical needs with a prior notice of 48 hours.

5.3 Attendance and Timekeeping

- Attendance is recorded through the biometric/RFID access system (office) and the PeopleHub app (for WFH, clock-in and clock-out).
- A grace of 15 minutes is allowed for late arrival up to **3 times a month**. The fourth late arrival and subsequent ones are treated as half-day Casual Leave (CL) or, if no leave is available, loss of pay (LOP) for half a day.
- Minimum 8 hours of recorded presence are required for a full day's attendance. Presence of less than 4.5 hours is treated as absent (LOP) unless leave is applied for.
- Missed punches and attendance corrections must be regularised in PeopleHub within **3 working days** with the manager's approval; the payroll cut-off is the 22nd of every month.
- Unauthorised absence for more than 3 consecutive working days is treated as **absconding**; the Company will issue notices to the employee's registered address and email, and if no response is received within 7 days, the services stand terminated.

5.4 Overtime and Compensatory Off

Overtime applies to non-exempt (G1-G2) employees for work over 9 hours on a working day, at twice the normal hourly wage, with a maximum of 50 overtime hours in a quarter in line with applicable law. Exempt employees who are required to work on a weekly off or on a public holiday for at least 4 hours are eligible for one day of **Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)** (half-day for 4 to 6 hours is not given; 6 hours or more earns a full day). Comp-offs need prior written approval from the manager and must be availed within **60 days** of earning; they lapse after that and cannot be encashed.

5.5 Dress Code and Workplace Conduct

ABC follows a "smart casual" dress code on all days. Clean, presentable and professional attire is required. Formal business attire is required when meeting clients or visitors. Employees may wear traditional or religious attire and are not required to remove symbols of faith. Casual wear such as shorts, torn jeans or slippers is not permitted in client-facing areas. Every employee must display their ID card on the Company premises. Smoking is allowed only in designated zones, and the consumption of alcohol or other intoxicating substances on the Company premises or at Company events within office hours is strictly prohibited.

5.6 Meetings and Communication

- Meeting-free focus time applies on **Wednesday afternoons (14:00-17:00)** and every day before 10:30 for engineering teams.
- Official communication takes place on Microsoft Teams and Company e-mail; WhatsApp or personal channels must not be used to share confidential client information.
- Employees are not expected to respond to work messages after 20:00 or during leave and weekends, except for on-call engineers, who follow the paged on-call rota and receive on-call allowances of INR 1,500 per week.

5.7 Holiday Calendar

ABC observes **12 fixed public holidays** and **2 floating holidays** in each calendar year. The list for the year 2026 is shown below; the final calendar is published by Admin by 15 December every year. Floating holidays are chosen by the employee from a notified list (such as Eid-ul-Fitr, Rath Yatra, Saraswati Puja, Guru Nanak Jayanti, Christmas Eve, Mahavir Jayanti) and applied for at least 7 days in advance.

Date (2026)	Holiday	Date (2026)	Holiday
26 Jan (Mon)	Republic Day	2 Oct (Fri)	Gandhi Jayanti
4 Mar (Wed)	Holi (Dol Jatra)	19 Oct (Mon)	Maha Ashtami
3 Apr (Fri)	Good Friday	20 Oct (Tue)	Vijaya Dashami (Dussehra)
14 Apr (Tue)	Poila Baishakh (Bengali New Year)	9 Nov (Mon)	Diwali / Kali Puja (observed)
1 May (Fri)	May Day (Labour Day)	25 Dec (Fri)	Christmas Day
15 Aug (Sat)	Independence Day (falls on weekend; no substitute)	8 May (Fri)	Rabindra Jayanti

Holiday dates are indicative for demonstration. Offices in Bengaluru, Pune and Hyderabad may substitute regional holidays (e.g., Ugadi, Ganesh Chaturthi, Bonalu) in place of Bengal-specific holidays, keeping the total at 12.

6. Leave Policy

6.1 Leave Year and General Rules

The leave year runs from **1 January to 31 December**. Leave entitlements are credited as per the schedule below and are pro-rated by completed months for employees joining or leaving during the year (a joining on or before the 15th earns the full month). Leave must be applied for in PeopleHub and approved by the reporting manager. Unplanned leave (sickness, emergency) should be intimated to the manager by phone or message before 10:00 on the same day, followed by an application in PeopleHub within 2 working days. Weekly offs and public holidays that fall within a period of leave are not counted as leave, except in the case of sandwich rules mentioned in 6.7.

6.2 Summary of Leave Entitlements

Leave type	Annual entitlement	Carry forward	Encashment	Key conditions
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	No	No	Max 3 consecutive days; credited upfront in January
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	No	No	Medical certificate required for 3 or more consecutive days
Privilege / Earned Leave (PL)	18 days (1.5 days per month)	Up to 36 days	Yes, at separation, up to 36 days; basic pay / 26	Minimum 3 consecutive days per application when planned; apply 7 days in advance for more than 5 days
Maternity Leave	26 weeks (first two children); 12 weeks (third child onward)	N/A	N/A	Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 as amended; medical documents needed
Paternity Leave	10 working days	No	No	To be availed within 6 months of the child's birth
Adoption Leave	12 weeks	N/A	N/A	For primary adopting parent of a child below 3 months or as per the law
Marriage Leave	5 working days (once in service)	No	No	Application with invitation card or registration proof
Bereavement Leave	5 working days per event	No	No	Death of spouse, child, parent, sibling or parent-in-law; extra 3 days if travel of more than 500 km
Wellness Days	2 days	No	No	No reason needed; to be applied at least 1 day in advance
Volunteer Day	1 day	No	No	For approved CSR activity in the ABC Sparsha programme
Compensatory Off	As earned	Valid 60 days	No	See Section 5.4

6.3 Casual Leave and Sick Leave

Casual Leave is meant for short, urgent and personal needs. Casual Leave cannot be clubbed with Privilege Leave for more than 7 consecutive days in total. Sick Leave may be used for the employee's own illness, or to care for a dependent child, spouse or parent who is ill, with supporting evidence. If an employee has exhausted Sick Leave, the Company allows the use of CL and PL; further absence is treated as Loss of Pay. Sick leave of more than 5 consecutive days needs a fitness certificate before resuming duty.

6.4 Privilege Leave (Earned Leave)

PL is credited at 1.5 days at the end of every completed month of service (18 days a year). Probationers can accrue PL but can avail of it only after confirmation, except in a medical emergency approved by the HRBP. The PL balance is capped at 36 days; any accrual beyond the cap lapses on 31 December. Public holidays and weekly offs occurring between PL days are not counted, but weekly offs falling immediately before and after a block of 5 or more days of PL taken with unapproved leave are counted as leave (sandwich rule).

6.5 Maternity, Paternity and Adoption Benefits

- **Maternity:** A woman employee who has worked for at least 80 days in the 12 months preceding the expected delivery date is eligible for 26 weeks of paid leave (up to 8 weeks may be taken before the expected delivery date). Miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy entitles 6 weeks of paid leave; tubectomy 2 weeks; illness arising from pregnancy, delivery or premature birth - 1 month.
- **Work-from-home after maternity:** after the maternity leave period, an employee may request up to 3 months of work from home, subject to the nature of the role. **Creche:** ABC has tie-ups with day-care centres near Kolkata and Bengaluru offices and reimburses up to INR 6,000 per month for children up to 4 years of age.
- **Paternity:** 10 working days of paid leave, which may be taken in one block or two blocks, within 6 months from the date of birth.
- **Return-to-work programme ("Navya"):** women returning after career breaks of 6 months to 5 years can apply to a 12-month supported re-entry with flexible hours and mentorship.

6.6 Loss of Pay (LOP) and Leave Without Pay

Any absence that is not covered by available leave leads to Loss of Pay. One day of LOP is deducted at the rate of (monthly gross salary / calendar days in the month). Leave without pay of up to 30 days in a service year may be sanctioned for personal reasons, with the approval of the Department Head and HRBP. Prolonged leave without pay of over 30 days affects the confirmation, increment and PL accrual period.

6.7 Other Leave Rules

- **Sandwich rule:** if an employee takes unplanned leave on both the working day before and after a weekly off or public holiday, the intervening off or holiday is counted as leave.
- **Leave during notice period:** PL cannot be availed during the notice period without HRBP approval, and leave taken in the notice period extends the last working day day-for-day, except in the case of medical emergencies.
- **Sabbatical:** employees with 7 or more years of service at G4 and above may apply for an unpaid sabbatical of 1 to 3 months, once in their career at ABC, for education, caregiving or personal projects; group medical insurance continues during the sabbatical.
- **Leave records:** an employee should check the balance in PeopleHub on the 1st of every month and raise discrepancies with HR Operations within 15 days.

7. Compensation and Benefits Policy

7.1 Philosophy

ABC's pay philosophy is "pay for performance, pay fair, pay competitively". Salary bands are benchmarked each year against the 60th percentile of an independent IT industry survey. Pay decisions are internally equitable, and the Company runs an annual pay-parity audit by gender and grade.

7.2 Salary Structure

Component	Description	Taxability / Remarks
Basic salary	40% of fixed CTC	Base for PF, gratuity and leave encashment
House Rent Allowance (HRA)	50% of basic (Kolkata, Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Chennai); 40% of basic elsewhere	Exemption subject to the tax regime opted by the employee
Special allowance	Balancing component	Fully taxable
Employer PF contribution	12% of basic (or the statutory wage ceiling of INR 15,000, as opted)	Part of CTC
Gratuity	4.81% of basic	Part of CTC; paid after 5 years of continuous service as per the Payment of Gratuity Act
Meal and wellness card	INR 2,200 per month	Optional; under the old tax regime
Variable pay (Performance Bonus)	Target % of fixed CTC by grade (see 7.3)	Paid annually in June, depends on company and individual performance

7.3 Variable Pay (Performance Bonus)

Grade	Target variable (% of fixed CTC)	Company vs. individual weight
G1 - G2	5%	50 / 50
G3 - G4	8% - 10%	40 / 60
G5 - G6	12% - 15%	40 / 60
G7 - G8	20% - 25%	50 / 50
G9	30% and above	As per Board HR Committee

Payout is zero for individuals with a rating of 1 ("Needs Improvement"), 0.6x for rating 2, 1.0x for rating 3, 1.25x for rating 4 and up to 1.5x for rating 5, multiplied by a company performance factor between 0.5 and 1.25 determined by the Board. Employees who join after 1 October are not eligible for that year's performance bonus, and employees who resign or are terminated before the payout date forfeit it.

7.4 Annual Increments

Rating	Description	Indicative increment range
5	Outstanding	12% - 18%
4	Exceeds Expectations	8% - 12%
3	Meets Expectations	5% - 8%
2	Partially Meets Expectations	0% - 3%
1	Needs Improvement	0%

Increments are effective from **1 April** each year and communicated by 30 April. Employees who join after 1 October are considered for increment in the next cycle. Increment ranges are indicative; the actual percentage depends on the business performance, the position in the salary band and market positioning.

7.5 Payroll Rules

- Salary is credited on the **last working day** of each month. Payslips are available on PeopleHub by the 3rd of the next month.
- Statutory deductions: Provident Fund (employee 12% of basic), Professional Tax (as per West Bengal and other state rules), Income Tax (TDS) and Labour Welfare Fund where applicable.
- Investment declarations are collected in April (estimated) and December (final proof); wrong or delayed declarations may lead to higher TDS in the last quarter.
- Overpayments are recoverable in up to 3 instalments, with the employee's written intimation. Salary information is confidential, and employees must not discuss their individual compensation with colleagues in a manner that causes disruption or discontent.

7.6 Insurance and Welfare Benefits

Benefit	Coverage	Details
Group Mediclaim	INR 5,00,000 floater	Employee, spouse, up to 2 children, premium paid by ABC; cashless at 4,500+ network hospitals; maternity cover up to INR 75,000 normal and 1,00,000 caesarean
Parents' cover	INR 3,00,000 (optional)	Premium deducted from the employee's salary at the Company's group rate
Group Term Life	3x annual fixed CTC (min. INR 15 lakh)	Paid to the nominee in case of death in service
Group Personal Accident	INR 10,00,000	Accidental death or permanent total disability
Annual health check-up	Free	Once a year for all employees; twice a year for employees aged 40 and above
Employee Assistance Programme (EAP)	24x7 confidential counselling	8 free sessions per year per employee and family member, helpline 1800-000-0000 (illustrative)

Benefit	Coverage	Details
Gym and sports reimbursement	INR 6,000 per year	On submission of invoices from registered facilities
ESOP (ABC Employee Stock Option Plan 2022)	Grade G5 and above, and top performers	4-year vesting: 10% / 20% / 30% / 40%; minimum 2 years of service to be eligible
Long-service awards	Cash and gift	INR 10,000 at 5 years, INR 25,000 at 10 years, INR 50,000 at 15 years

7.7 Allowances and Reimbursements

- **Internet and utility:** INR 1,000 per month under the WFH criteria in Section 5.2.
- **Mobile and data:** G5 and above can claim up to INR 1,500 per month; G8 and above INR 3,000.
- **Learning allowance:** see Section 10.
- **Transport:** free shuttle service on fixed routes for all offices; employees on night shifts receive door-to-door cab service. Employees who drive can use free parking.
- **Reimbursement claims** must be submitted in PeopleHub within 30 days of the expense with original bills, and are settled within 10 working days of manager approval.

8. Employee Code of Conduct and Ethics

8.1 Core Expectations

Every ABC employee is expected to act honestly, protect the Company's and clients' interests, comply with applicable laws and treat colleagues with respect. The Code of Conduct is acknowledged by each employee at joining and refreshed annually through a mandatory e-learning module with an assessment score of at least 80%.

8.2 Conflict of Interest and Outside Activities

- Employees must disclose any personal, financial or family interest that may conflict with ABC's business using the Conflict of Interest declaration, annually and whenever the situation changes.
- Employees cannot work for a competitor, client or vendor, or run a competing business, while employed with ABC. Approved side activities (teaching, writing, open-source contributions, non-profit work) are permitted only with prior written approval from the HRBP and must not use Company time, assets or confidential information.
- Employees must not be involved in selecting or supervising a close relative. Relationships between a manager and a direct or indirect report must be disclosed to HR, and the reporting line will be changed.

8.3 Gifts, Hospitality and Anti-Bribery

ABC has a zero-tolerance approach to bribery and corruption, in line with the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 and the UK Bribery Act, 2010. Employees may accept gifts or hospitality only if it is of nominal value (not more than **INR 2,500 per occasion and INR 10,000 per year** from a single source), is not given to influence a decision, and is declared in the Gifts Register. Cash or cash equivalents must never be accepted. Offering anything of value to a government official to obtain a business advantage is strictly prohibited.

8.4 Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

ABC is committed to a workplace free from sexual harassment, as per the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. The Company's Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) has a woman Presiding Officer (a senior leader), at least two employee members committed to the cause of women, and one external member from an NGO or legal background. Key features:

- A written complaint can be sent to **icc@abc-pvt.example** or submitted in person within **3 months** from the date of the incident (extendable by 3 more months for good reasons).
- The ICC completes the inquiry within **90 days** and provides its report to the employer within 10 days of completion. The employer acts within 60 days of receiving the report.
- Conciliation is possible only at the request of the complainant, and monetary settlement is not allowed as a basis for conciliation.

- Confidentiality of complainants, respondents and witnesses is strictly maintained. Retaliation against any person who files a complaint or participates in an inquiry is a major misconduct.
- All employees complete POSH awareness training annually. Interim measures such as a transfer, leave of up to 3 months or restricted contact may be given to the complainant during the inquiry.

8.5 Whistleblower Policy

Employees, contractors and vendors can raise concerns about suspected fraud, bribery, financial misreporting, data theft, safety violations or serious breaches of the Code through the independent Ethics Helpline (**ethics@abc-pvt.example** or toll-free 1800-000-0001, hosted by an external provider, available 24x7, anonymous reporting possible). Concerns are reviewed by the Ethics and Whistleblower Committee chaired by an independent director. Acknowledgement is given within 3 working days and the investigation concludes within 60 days in most cases. Any retaliation against a whistleblower acting in good faith is strictly prohibited and will lead to disciplinary action.

8.6 Equal Opportunity, Anti-Discrimination and Bullying

Discrimination, bullying, victimisation, intimidation, hate speech and derogatory remarks on the basis of gender, religion, caste, race, nationality, language, disability, sexual orientation, gender identity, age or marital status are not tolerated. Employees can raise concerns through their HRBP, the GRC or the Ethics Helpline. ABC also supports employee-led resource groups: **Women@ABC**, **Pride@ABC** and **AbleTogether**.

8.7 Social Media and Public Statements

Employees may express their personal views on social media but must make it clear that these are personal and not the views of the Company. Confidential information, client names (unless publicly approved), financial results, unreleased products, or internal screenshots must not be posted. Only authorised spokespersons from Marketing and Communications may speak to the media on behalf of ABC.

9. Performance Management and Career Progression

9.1 Performance Cycle

Period	Activity
April	Goal setting (OKRs and competency goals) completed within the first 30 days of the cycle
October	Mid-year check-in conversation; goals can be revised for business change
January - February	Self-assessment, peer feedback (3-5 reviewers) and manager assessment
February - March	Calibration by Department Heads and HRBPs for rating consistency and forced-distribution guidelines
March - April	Rating communication, feedback conversation, increment and promotion letters

9.2 Rating Scale and Distribution

Employees are rated on a 5-point scale (see the table in Section 7.4). To ensure differentiation, the guided distribution is approximately 5-10% for rating 5, 20-25% for rating 4, 50-55% for rating 3, 10-15% for rating 2 and below 5% for rating 1. An employee who disagrees with the rating can appeal in writing to the HRBP within 10 working days of rating communication; the GRC reviews and decides in 15 working days. The decision is final.

9.3 Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)

- Employees rated 1 or 2, or whose performance is observed to be consistently below expectations, may be placed on a PIP with defined goals for **60 to 90 days**.
- The manager and HRBP hold a documented kick-off meeting, with fortnightly review meetings. The employee may seek support from a mentor or the L and D team.
- Outcomes: (a) successful closure; (b) extension of up to 30 days; or (c) separation from the Company following the notice period or payment in lieu. Employees on PIP are not eligible for promotion, internal transfer or increments during the PIP.

9.4 Promotion Policy

Promotions are considered once a year, effective 1 April, and in exceptional cases at the mid-year review (effective 1 October). Eligibility: minimum 18 months in the current grade (12 months for G1-G2 high-performers), a rating of 4 or above in the last cycle (or 3 in two consecutive cycles), demonstration of next-level competencies, and availability of a role and budget. Promotion increases are typically 8-15% of fixed pay and cannot be given for more than one grade at a time. G6 and above require CHRO and CEO approval.

9.5 Recognition Programmes

- **Spot Awards:** INR 2,000 to INR 10,000 awarded by managers for outstanding contributions (budget: INR 1,500 per employee per year at department level).
- **Star of the Quarter:** INR 25,000 and a trophy for the top individual and top team in each department.
- **Founders' Award:** annual award of INR 1,00,000 for the most impactful contribution to ABC's values.

10. Learning and Development Policy

- **Learning hours:** every employee must complete at least **40 hours of learning** per year; managers and above must complete 16 of these hours in leadership topics. Learning is tracked on the ABC Academy portal.
- **Mandatory courses** (within 30 days of joining, then annually): Code of Conduct, Information Security Awareness, POSH, Anti-Bribery, and Data Privacy.
- **Certification support:** ABC pays the examination and course fees for job-relevant certifications (cloud, security, data, project management) up to **INR 50,000 per employee per year**, with prior approval from the manager and L and D. A lock-in of 12 months applies; if the employee leaves earlier, the fee is recovered proportionately. A one-time cash incentive of INR 5,000 is given on successful completion of a high-value certification (such as AWS Professional or CISSP).
- **Higher education support:** employees at G3 and above with 3 or more years of service and a rating of 4 or above may be sponsored for part-time degrees (MBA, M.Tech), covering 50% of tuition fees up to INR 2,00,000, with a service bond of 24 months after completion.
- **Leadership development:** a first-time manager programme ("Lead 1.0") covering 6 months, and the senior leadership programme with an external business school for G6 and above.
- **Mentoring:** every employee in the first year of service is assigned a buddy for 90 days and a mentor in the first year. Employees at G1-G2 can opt for reverse mentoring with a senior leader.
- **Internal gigs and rotation:** employees can spend up to 20% of their time on internal projects approved by their manager, and job rotation across departments is possible after 24 months in a role.

11. Disciplinary Policy and Grievance Redressal

11.1 Categories of Misconduct

Category	Examples	Typical consequence
Minor	Repeated late arrival, minor policy breaches, unprofessional behaviour, non-completion of mandatory training	Verbal counselling or written warning
Major	Unauthorised absence for 3+ days, violation of security policy, misuse of Company assets, insubordination, negligence causing client loss, falsifying records	Final written warning, suspension, increment or bonus withholding, demotion
Gross	Fraud, theft, sexual harassment (proved), violence, data leakage, bribery, forgery of documents, substance abuse at work, conflict of interest concealed, breach of client confidentiality	Termination for cause without notice period or severance; legal action where applicable

11.2 Disciplinary Procedure

- **Step 1 - Preliminary review:** the HRBP and the manager collect facts within 5 working days.
- **Step 2 - Show-cause notice:** a written notice to the employee with details of the allegations; the employee gets **3 working days** to respond.

- **Step 3 - Inquiry:** for major and gross misconduct, a domestic inquiry committee (HRBP, a senior manager from a different department and the Legal team) holds a fair hearing, in which the employee may present evidence and may be accompanied by a colleague.
- **Step 4 - Decision:** a written order is issued within **30 days** of the inquiry's start. The employee can appeal to the CHRO within 7 days.
- Suspension during the inquiry is with subsistence allowance of 50% of basic pay for the first 90 days, as per applicable law. Records of warnings remain on file for 24 months.

11.3 Grievance Redressal

Employees should be able to raise workplace concerns without fear. The following timelines apply:

Level	Authority	Acknowledgement	Resolution time
1	Reporting Manager	1 working day	3 working days
2	HRBP	1 working day	5 working days
3	Grievance Redressal Committee	2 working days	10 working days
4	CHRO	2 working days	15 working days

The GRC includes the CHRO's nominee, a Department Head from outside the concerned department, a Legal representative and an employee representative elected every 2 years. Anonymous grievances are accepted via the Ethics Helpline, but the Company's ability to investigate may be limited.

12. Separation, Exit and Retirement Policy

12.1 Resignation and Notice Period

Grade	Notice period (confirmed employee)	During probation
G1 - G3	30 days	15 days
G4 - G5	60 days	15 days
G6 - G9	90 days	30 days

- Resignation must be submitted in writing, or through PeopleHub, to the reporting manager with a copy to the HRBP. The Company will accept or reject it, in writing, within 7 working days.
- Notice period buy-out: the employee may request an early release by paying the salary for the unserved notice days (basic plus fixed allowances). A buy-out is at the sole discretion of the Company and can be denied if the employee is on critical projects or under investigation. Employees may be released earlier at the Company's option, and the Company can pay in lieu of notice at its discretion (in which case the employee is not required to pay).
- A notice period of up to 30 days can be waived by the Company for the employee on request in exceptional cases. A resignation can be withdrawn within 7 days of submission with the manager's consent.
- Employees must complete knowledge transfer, return all Company assets (laptop, access card, documents), clear all dues and attend the exit interview before the last working day.

12.2 Full and Final Settlement (F and F)

F and F includes salary up to the last working day, PL encashment (maximum 36 days), gratuity (if eligible), bonus or incentive (if eligible and as per policy), minus notice period shortfall, advances, clawbacks, and tax. The F and F amount is paid within **45 days** of the last working day, subject to the clearance from all departments. The experience letter and relieving letter are issued within 7 working days of completion of the clearance. PF transfer or withdrawal is facilitated through the employee's UAN, and a Form 16 is issued by 15 June for the financial year of exit.

12.3 Gratuity

Gratuity is paid to employees who have completed 5 years of continuous service, on resignation, retirement, death or disablement (no minimum for death or disablement), as per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972. It is calculated as (last drawn basic pay + dearness allowance) x 15/26 x number of completed years of service, rounded off (service of more than 6 months in the last year is counted as a full year), with a statutory maximum of INR 20 lakh. Gratuity may be forfeited, wholly or partly, in case of termination for gross misconduct involving damage or loss to the Company, as

provided by law.

12.4 Termination by the Company

The Company may terminate employment: (a) for poor performance after an unsuccessful PIP, by giving the notice period or payment in lieu; (b) for misconduct, after the disciplinary procedure; (c) for business reasons, including restructuring and redundancy, with the notice period and severance of **15 days of basic pay for each completed year of service** (in addition to statutory retrenchment compensation where applicable); (d) for misrepresentation or failing the background verification. Termination for gross misconduct does not require a notice period or severance.

12.5 Retirement

The normal retirement age at ABC is **60 years**. An employee retires on the last day of the month in which they turn 60. Retirees receive gratuity, PL encashment, a farewell recognition, and are eligible for the "ABC Alumni" network, post-retirement medical insurance on a self-paid group basis, and consulting assignments of up to 12 months, if business requires.

12.6 Exit Interview and Alumni Network

An exit interview is conducted by the HRBP or an independent party in the last week of notice. Insights are used anonymously for retention planning. ABC Alumni is open to all former employees who left in good standing; alumni get priority in the rehire process and access to learning webinars.

13. Health, Safety and Wellness Policy

- **Workplace safety:** all offices comply with fire safety and building norms. Fire drills are conducted twice a year, and all visitors must register at the reception. Floor wardens and first-aid-trained staff are available on all floors; each office has a doctor on call and an on-site medical room (Kolkata and Bengaluru: nurse present during working hours).
- **Incident reporting:** any accident, injury, near-miss or hazard must be reported to Admin and HR within 24 hours using the Safety Incident Form or on PeopleHub.
- **Women's safety:** women working between 20:00 and 07:00 are provided with cab service with a security guard or a GPS-tracked vehicle; the driver's police verification is mandatory, and women are dropped first and picked up last.
- **Mental health:** through the EAP, mental-health first-aiders at each office, quarterly wellbeing webinars and an annual "Wellness Week". Managers receive training to identify signs of burnout.
- **Infectious disease:** in the event of an epidemic or pandemic, employees may be required to work from home, report symptoms and follow guidelines issued by the government and the Crisis Management Team.
- **Substance-free workplace:** use, possession or distribution of illegal drugs is prohibited and may lead to termination. Support for employees seeking rehabilitation is available through the EAP, without penalty for voluntary disclosure.

14. Information Security and IT Usage Policy

14.1 Acceptable Use

- Company laptops and accounts are for business use; limited personal use is allowed if it does not violate policies or affect productivity. All activities on Company systems may be monitored as per the law.
- Passwords must have at least 12 characters, must be changed every 90 days and cannot be shared. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for e-mail, VPN and cloud consoles.
- USB mass storage devices are blocked by default. Exceptions are given by the CISO for a limited period. Installing unlicensed or unapproved software is prohibited.
- Personal devices (BYOD) may access Company e-mail and Teams only through the Mobile Device Management (MDM) app, which allows the Company to wipe only work data in case of loss.
- Employees should lock their screens when leaving the desk and follow a clean-desk policy. Visitors must be escorted in secure areas.

14.2 Data Classification and Client Confidentiality

Class	Description	Examples	Handling
Public	Approved for public release	Marketing brochures, blog posts	No restriction
Internal	For employees only	Policies, org charts, internal announcements	Do not share externally
Confidential	Sensitive business or client data	Client source code, contracts, financials	Encrypted storage, need-to-know access
Restricted	Highly sensitive or regulated data	Personal data (PII), health or payment data, credentials	Encryption in transit and at rest, access logging, approval from the data owner

Confidentiality obligations continue for **3 years after the end of employment** (indefinitely for trade secrets and personal data). All inventions, code and documents created during employment, using Company resources or in the course of work, belong to ABC as per the Intellectual Property clause in the employment agreement.

14.3 Use of Generative AI Tools

Employees may use only the Company-approved AI assistants (enterprise-licensed) for work. Source code, client data, personal data or other confidential information must not be entered into public or unapproved AI tools. AI-generated output must be reviewed by a human for accuracy, bias and licensing before it is used in client deliverables, and AI use must be disclosed to the client where the contract requires it.

14.4 Security Incidents

Lost devices, phishing e-mails, malware alerts or suspected data breaches must be reported to the Security Operations Centre (soc@abc-pvt.example, extension 4911) immediately and in any event within **2 hours** of discovery. Quick reporting is never penalised, but failure to report may lead to disciplinary action. Personal data breaches are notified to the regulator and affected parties as per the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

15. Travel and Expense Policy

15.1 Business Travel Entitlements

Grade	Air travel (domestic)	Hotel (per night, metro)	Hotel (per night, non-metro)	Daily allowance (meals, local travel)
G1 - G3	Economy (rail 3AC preferred under 500 km)	INR 5,000	INR 3,500	INR 800
G4 - G5	Economy	INR 7,500	INR 5,000	INR 1,200
G6 - G7	Economy (premium economy on request for flights over 4 hours)	INR 10,000	INR 7,000	INR 1,800
G8 - G9	Business class for flights over 3 hours	Actuals (reasonable)	Actuals (reasonable)	INR 2,500

- Travel must be pre-approved in the Travel Desk module by the manager and booked through the Company's travel partner at least 7 days in advance; late bookings need Department Head approval.
- International travel needs additional approval from the COO (CEO for G8 and above), a valid visa, travel insurance and a forex advance of up to 80% of the estimated expenses.
- Personal car use for business is reimbursed at INR 12 per km (INR 5 per km for two-wheelers); taxis and cab aggregators are reimbursed on actuals for official trips only.

15.2 Expense Claims

Expense claims must be submitted in PeopleHub within **30 days** of travel or expenditure, with original receipts for any single expense above INR 500. Claims over 60 days old are rejected unless approved by the CFO. Fraudulent claims (such as inflated bills or fake receipts) are treated as gross misconduct. Alcohol is not reimbursable. Entertainment expenses for clients require prior approval and are limited to INR 3,000 per person.

16. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How many days of Privilege Leave can I carry forward?

A: You can carry forward PL up to a maximum balance of 36 days. Any PL above 36 days lapses on 31 December. Casual Leave and Sick Leave cannot be carried forward.

Q: What is the notice period for a Senior Manager (G6)?

A: The notice period for G6 is 90 days. During probation, it is 30 days for G6 and above.

Q: How many times can I be late without a salary or leave deduction?

A: Up to 3 late arrivals of 15 minutes each per month are allowed. From the fourth, half-day CL (or LOP) is deducted.

Q: Which days do I need to be in the office?

A: Under the 3-2 Flex model, Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday are office days. Monday and Friday can be WFH with the manager's approval.

Q: How long is maternity leave?

A: 26 weeks for the first two children and 12 weeks from the third child. Paternity leave is 10 working days.

Q: When is the annual increment effective?

A: On 1 April every year. Employees who joined after 1 October of the previous year are considered in the next cycle.

Q: How much referral bonus will I get for referring a Senior Engineer (G4)?

A: INR 50,000, paid after the referred employee completes 90 days of service.

Q: What is the probation period?

A: 6 months for G1 to G5 and 3 months for G6 and above, extendable once by up to 3 months.

Q: Can I take up a part-time job or freelance work?

A: No. Dual employment is not allowed. Approved side activities such as teaching or non-profit work need the prior written approval of the HRBP.

Q: What is the amount of the joining bonus clawback?

A: 100% if you leave within 12 months of joining and 50% if you leave between 12 and 18 months.

Q: How do I report sexual harassment?

A: Write to icc@abc-pvt.example within 3 months of the incident. The ICC completes the inquiry within 90 days and keeps your identity confidential.

Q: When will my full and final settlement be paid?

A: Within 45 days of your last working day, after all departmental clearances.

Q: What is the health insurance cover?

A: INR 5 lakh family floater (self, spouse, up to 2 children) paid by ABC, with an optional INR 3 lakh cover for parents at group rates.

Q: How many hours of learning must I complete in a year?

A: At least 40 hours, tracked on the ABC Academy portal.

Q: What is the retirement age?

A: 60 years, on the last day of the month in which the employee turns 60.

Q: How much is the gift limit I can accept from a vendor?

A: INR 2,500 per occasion and INR 10,000 per year from one source, and it must be declared in the Gifts Register.

17. Contacts, Glossary and Document Control

17.1 Key Contacts

Need	Contact	Details
General HR queries	HR Helpdesk	hr-helpdesk@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4100
Payroll and payslips	HR Operations and Payroll	payroll@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4120
Recruitment and referrals	Talent Acquisition	careers@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4130
Benefits and insurance	Compensation and Benefits	benefits@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4140
Learning and certifications	L and D (ABC Academy)	academy@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4150
Sexual harassment complaints	Internal Complaints Committee	icc@abc-pvt.example
Ethics and whistleblower	Ethics Helpline (external)	ethics@abc-pvt.example | 1800-000-0001
Security incidents	Security Operations Centre	soc@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4911
IT support	Internal IT Systems	it-support@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4000
Travel desk and facilities	Admin and Facilities	admin@abc-pvt.example | Ext. 4200

17.2 Glossary

Term	Meaning
CTC	Cost to Company - total annual cost of an employee, including fixed pay, employer contributions and benefits
PeopleHub	ABC's HRMS portal for attendance, leave, payroll, requisitions, performance and claims
HRBP	Human Resources Business Partner assigned to a department
GRC	Grievance Redressal Committee
ICC	Internal Complaints Committee under the POSH Act, 2013
PIP	Performance Improvement Plan
LOP	Loss of Pay - unpaid absence
PL / CL / SL	Privilege Leave / Casual Leave / Sick Leave
GET	Graduate Engineer Trainee
F and F	Full and Final settlement of dues at separation
UAN	Universal Account Number for Provident Fund

17.3 Policy Amendments and Document Control

ABC reserves the right to amend, withdraw or interpret any policy in this handbook, with notice to employees through PeopleHub and e-mail. In case of conflict between this handbook and the law, the law prevails. In case of different interpretations, the decision of the CHRO is final. Individual employment contracts apply where they are more beneficial to the employee and consistent with the law.

Version	Date	Summary of change	Approved by
4.2	01 Apr 2026	Added 3-2 Flex hybrid model, updated referral bonus, Gen AI usage policy, increased certification support to INR 50,000	CHRO, Board HR Committee
4.1	01 Apr 2025	Revised leave policy (Wellness Days, Volunteer Day), PL cap increased to 36 days	CHRO
4.0	01 Apr 2024	Complete re-write and consolidation of 11 separate HR policies into one handbook	Board HR Committee
3.0	01 Apr 2022	Introduction of ESOP, POSH update and whistleblower mechanism	Managing Director

End of document. ABC Private Limited is a fictional company created for demonstration and RAG testing purposes. Contact numbers and e-mail addresses are placeholders.